

BUILDING DIGITAL FOUNDATIONS: PROCESS & SCOPE MAPPING

County of Marin | J\

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Keywords:

User Experience Research, Change Management, Digital Transformation

Summary:

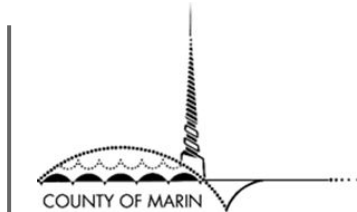
In late 2025, Marin County launched their non-emergency incident-reporting app, FixItMarin, increasing accessibility for citizens to alert problems they discover in their community. From the evolution of formally processing citizen requests through phone calls to a newly acquired CRM system, departments were also introduced to digitally managing their requests. The goal of my project was to describe the lifecycle of these requests such that they followed other ticket managing best practices and addressed citizens feedback of the app so that we boost both the adoption of FixItMarin County and build trust between citizens and their government.

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Department of Innovation and Technology Office

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coding it forward >



OCTAVIA SMITH

CONTEXT

Marin County & FixItMarin?

MARIN COUNTY

- Marin County is located in the northwestern part of the San Francisco Bay Area.
- **Population:** 262,321 (2020 Census)
- Biodiverse (Redwood forests, beaches & home to Mt. Tamalpais).
- Frank Lloyd Wright designed its Civic Center where its courthouse county services and departments live.



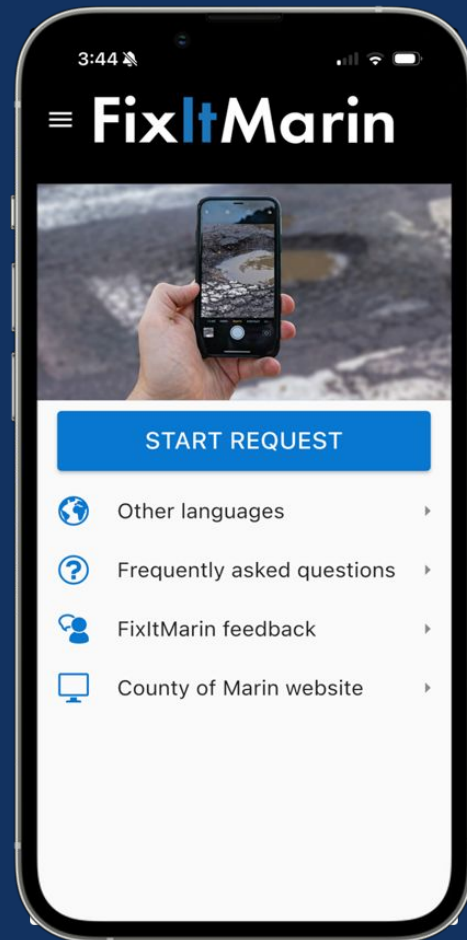
INVESTMENT IN TECHNOLOGY

- Marin County introduced their **Digital Innovation and Transformation** in 2025, which focused on **assessing current departmental processes** and **procuring new digital tools** that can adequately uphold them.
- This new department encourages **agile-like ideation and prototyping**, finding solutions to gaps in constituent-governmental engagement and **offering opportunities to better serve** the Marin community.

Introducing FixItMarin

- The County's first 311 non-emergency incident reporting app!
 - Traditionally, citizens would call a department to log requests, but is now available in their pockets!
 - First Product rollout included:
 - Department of Public Works' (DPW) Roads and Waste Management teams,
 - Parks
 - Community Development Agency

Fixit is quickly growing to include DPW's Storm Water and the County's internal Facility Management departments.



Since its launch, FixItMarin has acquired...

2,544

App Installs

1,300

Registered Users

1,200

Service Requests

Goldenside, 4017 Getty St and 20th Ave Friday, November 22, 2024 17:20:18
CS Office SuperMap - San Mateo 1/14/25



“What an incredible service. You are tackling all the small things that we have grown to tolerate. Thanks so much for doing such a great job.”

“This corner has been an issue for over a year and ya’ll got it fixed in under a week. Thank you!”

I had my doubts but you really took care of the problem and made the intersection safe again! Thank you so much. I will recommend you to everyone in San Rafael for fixing problems!

Problem Space

- With FixItMarin, reporting concerns has now become more available and accessible to citizens than ever, naturally **accelerating the number of requests** that departments receive.
- FixItMarin is a system that is **new to several county departments**, ushering an opportunity to define the **degree of customer engagement** as teams receive and manage citizen requests
- FixItMarin's scope extends *only* to **unincorporated areas within the county**, yet is available and marketed to all, creating confusion among residents about what *can* be addressed.

How can we define a ticket-management process such that it is easy to follow across departments and reflects their departmental needs?

How can we fulfill citizens' expectations of FixitMarin so that we continue to build positive governmental relationships?

APPROACH

METHODS USED

User Interviews

Used cadenced stakeholder calls with department heads to understand current state processes, pain points and opportunities for optimization

Researched ticket management best practices and principles to determine which would best suit the County

Quantitative Research

Evaluated customer surveys to identify trends within the ticket-management lifecycle open for improvement

Classified historical closed ticket data to provide insight on in-scope tickets and scenarios

Competitive Analysis

Assessed the features and topics reportable by surrounding Bay-Area non-emergency apps for gaps and opportunities to expand services and coverage.

INSIGHTS

Result: An End-to-End (E2E) ticket management lifecycle currently used by the County highlighting its phases and conditions evaluated throughout each phase.

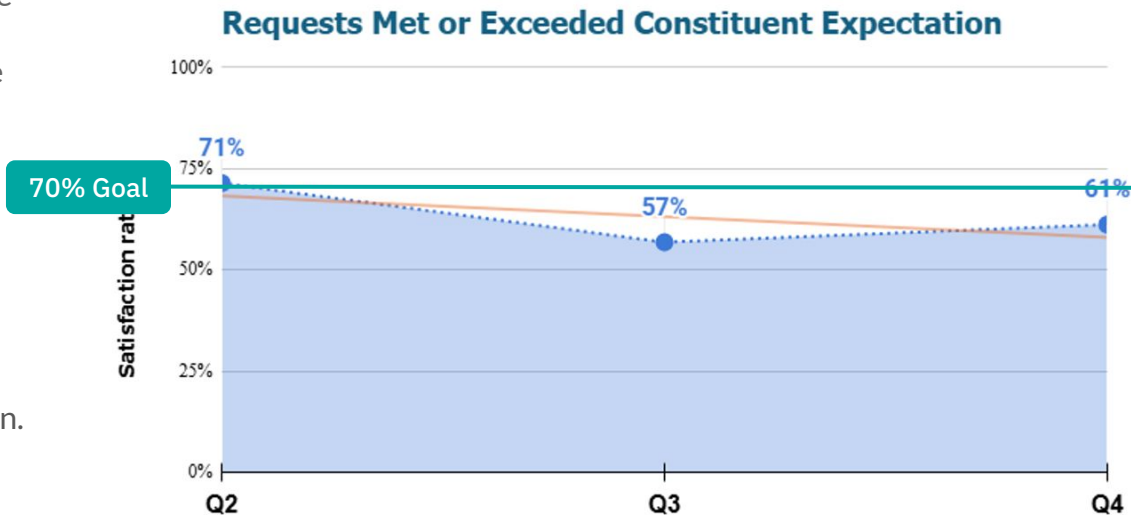


INSIGHTS: QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH

Result: An overview of how residents feel about the app. Constituent satisfaction reflects a small percentage of adopters. Since its launch in Q2, we've received more feedback that has driven incremental product improvement and have more opportunities to optimize such that we can meet our goal of 70% satisfaction.

Key Findings:

- Constituents are impressed by the County's speediness when addressing concerns.
- Constituents want more transparency on which phase of evaluation and resolution the ticket is in.
- Residents want more personable interactions when handling their tickets.



INSIGHTS: QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH

Result: Defined Guiding Principles to encourage ticket management etiquette internally among teammates and for citizens

Guiding Principles

Our framework for operational excellence



Transparent Public and Team Communication

Ex. Sending constituents updates as you progress through the ticket

We risk losing hard-earned public trust when a resident submits a ticket and receives no updates until marked "Closed". Transparency shows our community that we care and are addressing the problem.



Accountable, Evidence-based Administration

Ex. Using Statuses to reflect the stage of progress the ticket is in.

Every action throughout the lifecycle is supported by verifiable data. We manage requests with administrative integrity so that our system remains auditable, compliant and dependable from start to end.



Civic Courtesy & Proactive Care

Ex. Greeting the constituent at first contact

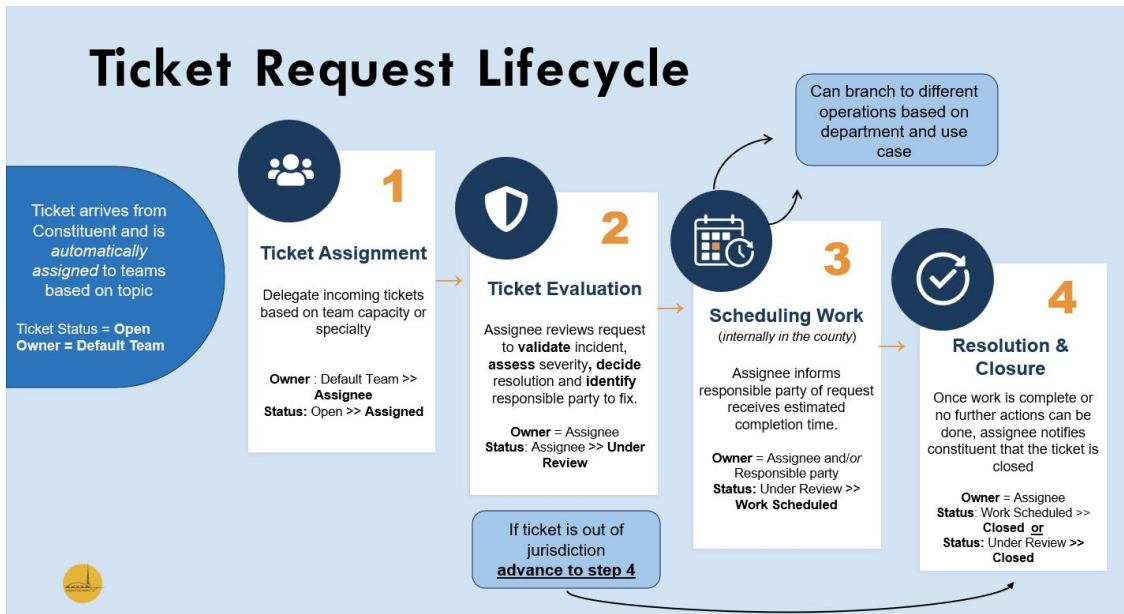
Our constituents deserve to feel heard, not just handled. Regularly checking in with the requestor removes anxiety about their request and humanizes county government operations.



INSIGHTS: QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH

Result: Created a baseline model for ticket management lifecycle that includes

- Ticket Phases
 - Descriptors of each phase
- Actions to take during each phase
- Who owns which action



INSIGHTS: COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS (ongoing)

Result: List of possible topics to add to FixItMarin.

- **Next Steps:**

- Determine how many tickets contain these keywords
- List the topics # of ticket occurrences
- Prioritize which topics based on popularity and feasibility

Reportable Topics	SF 311	San jose 311	Oakland 311	Miami Dade	San Rafael	FixItMarin
Abandoned Vehicle	☐	☐	☒	☒	☒	☒
Blocked Driveway & Illegal Parking	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Broken / Leaking Fire Hydrant	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐
Broken or Missing Manhole Cover	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐
Broken Parking Merer	☐	☐	☒	☐	☒	☐
Broken Sidewalk	☐	☐	☒	☒	☒	☒
Complaint about property owner	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Consumer Complaint to District Attorney	☐	☒	☒	☐	☐	☐
Curb/ Sidewalk Problems / Repars	☒	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐
Damaged Public Property	☒	☐	☒	☒	☐	☐
Damaged/Fallen Trees / Branches	☒	☐	☒	☐	☒	☒
Environmental Concerns	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐
Fire Hazard (Vegetation/Campsite)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐
Flooding or Draining Issues	☒	☐	☐	☒	☒	☒
Garbage Container Issues	☒	☒	☐	☒	☒	☐
Graffiti	☒	☐	☒	☒	☐	☐
Homeless/ Encampment Concerns	☒	☒	☒	☐	☒	☐
Illegal Dumping	☒	☒	☐	☐	☒	☒

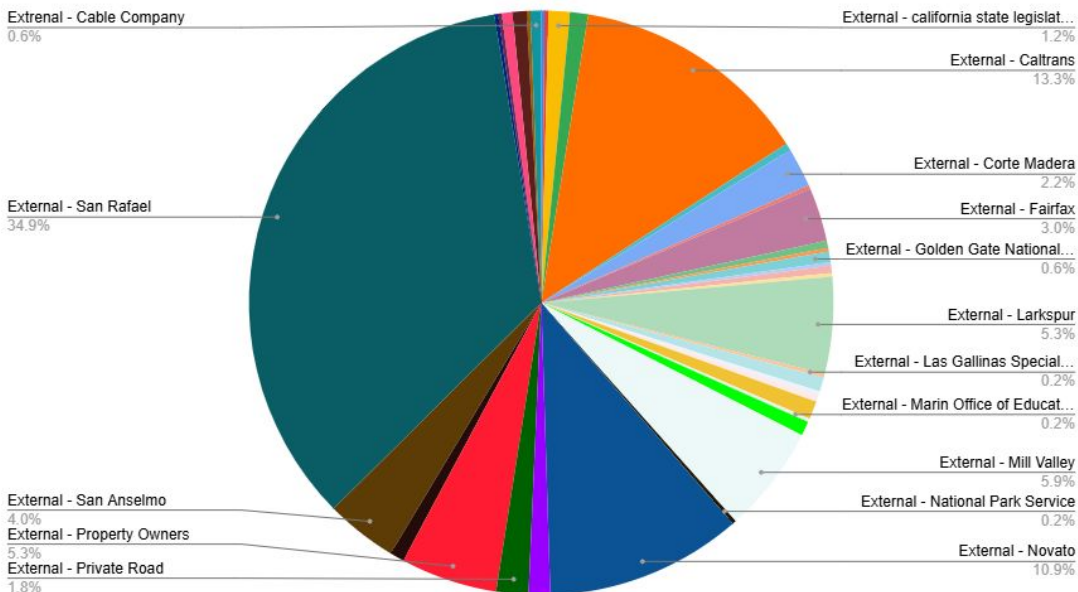
INSIGHTS: COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS (ongoing)

Result: A breakdown of where non-County responsible tickets are transferred to:

- **Next Steps:**

- Create an appendix of where to go to file requests for each organization
- Record length of time to complete external requests
- Determine whether departments could fill them out or have FixItMarin integrate through API calls. *(Which we've successfully done with our most impacting, San Rafael tickets!)*

Proportions of Tickets with Non-County responsibility



REFLECTIONS/LESSONS LEARNED

- Relationship building is essential, especially when being the harbinger of change. Change is difficult and can be perceived as oppositional and personal.
- Decisions take time, especially when you value quality and want to minimize risk. It's important to have alignment with all of the people who impact/have stake in the product beforehand.
- Product Management is fluid. There are some fundamental skills necessary, but ultimately is shaped by what your team needs.

Thank you all!

Jodi, Crosby, Matt, John, the County of Marin, CIF and my mentor Amy for this incredible experience!